SEO + GEO Audit: lacarstereo.com

Audit date: 2026-10-04 (UTC). Read-only audit; nothing was changed on any site or repo. Business: LA Car Stereo, an Audio MotorSports Inc shop, 22025 S Avalon Blvd Ste A, Carson CA 90745. Companion files: SCHEMA_REPORT.md, AI_SEARCH_REPORT.md, pages.csv (127 URLs).

Method and evidence limits

- Fetched with curl through the sandbox proxy on 2026-10-04: homepage, robots.txt, sitemap.xml, llms.txt, and every one of the 127 URLs in sitemap.xml (fetched on the apex host, lacarstereo.com). Parsed titles, meta, H1, robots meta, canonical, JSON-LD, images and links from the raw HTML.
- NOT verified (blocked or unavailable): the www host (www.lacarstereo.com returns a proxy 403, so I cannot confirm which host is primary or how www and apex redirect to each other); http:// to https:// redirect (proxy 403); Core Web Vitals and Lighthouse (PageSpeed API returned 429 quota exceeded; no field data); Google Search Console, GBP and Yelp data (no access); sister domains lacarbeats.com, lacartint.com, lacaralarm.com, amspods.com (proxy blocked). Anything marked "(unverified)" below is inference.
- The earlier STATUS.md said the site was unreachable. That was true at the time; the site was reachable on this run, so STATUS.md was removed.

Health summary (heuristic, not a Lighthouse score)

Area	Status	Note
Indexability	Critical	124 of 127 sitemap URLs carry `noindex, nofollow`; robots.txt disallows all crawlers
Technical	Mixed	Fast HTML (TTFB about 160 ms, cached), solid security headers, clean 404, but missing canonicals on 26 pages and host mismatch
On-page	Fair	Unique titles and descriptions on 126 of 127 pages, but product pages are thin and templated
Schema	Fair	Valid JSON-LD everywhere but no Product, no FAQPage, conflicting entity on /locations/ (see SCHEMA_REPORT.md)
Local SEO	Fair	NAP consistent and matches sister sites; only one indexable page; no city landing pages
AI / GEO	Critical	All AI crawlers blocked by robots.txt, no llms.txt (see AI_SEARCH_REPORT.md)

Overall: the site content is reasonably well built, but as deployed today it asks every search engine and AI crawler not to index it. If this is a pre-launch or staged state, treat finding 1 as a launch checklist item and confirm intent with the owner before changing anything (unverified: no evidence in the fetched files states the intent).

Findings

1. Critical: sitewide noindex, nofollow (Google)

Evidence: `<meta name="robots" content="noindex, nofollow">` on 124 of 127 sitemap URLs, including home, all 6 shop categories, all 7 install pages, /packages/, /faq/, /about/, /book/ and all 100+ product pages. Only /locations/, /privacy/ and /terms/ return `index, follow`. Extra pages not in the sitemap (/contact/, /reviews/, 4 spot-checked /packages// pages) are also noindex; /fit/ is `noindex, follow`. No X-Robots-Tag header was present.

Result: these pages cannot rank. Note the policy pages are indexable while the money pages are not, which looks inverted. Fix: remove the noindex in the page metadata template for pages that should rank; keep it on /cart/, /book/ confirmation states and /fit/ if desired. Re-verify with a fresh crawl.

2. Critical: robots.txt blocks everything except AdsBot (Google, AI)

Evidence (full file, 197 bytes):

```
User-Agent: AdsBot-Google        Allow: /
User-Agent: AdsBot-Google-Mobile Allow: /
User-Agent: Googlebot            Allow: /locations/
User-Agent: *                    Disallow: /
Sitemap: https://www.lacarstereo.com/sitemap.xml
```

Bingbot, GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, Google-Extended, Applebot and all others fall under `*` and are disallowed from the whole site. Googlebot has its own group containing only an Allow line; under RFC 9309 that group has no Disallow, so Googlebot is effectively allowed everywhere and then meets the noindex meta tags. The file looks intended as "only /locations/ for Google" but does not express that. A robots Disallow also stops crawlers from seeing a noindex, so the two controls conflict for Bing and others. Fix: replace with a single `User-agent: *` group using `Allow: /` plus `Disallow: /cart/` and `/book/` as needed (the sister site audiomotorsports.com documents why named allow-only groups should be avoided), and the www/apex-correct Sitemap line.

3. High: host mismatch between apex and www (Google)

Evidence: sitemap.xml, og:url, JSON-LD @id and product canonicals all use https://www.lacarstereo.com, but https://lacarstereo.com serves the pages with HTTP 200 and no redirect to www (verified on apex; www not reachable from here, unverified). Paths without a trailing slash 308-redirect to the slash version (verified for /contact and /reviews). Fix: pick one host, 301 the other, and make robots Sitemap, sitemap, canonicals, og:url and schema agree.

4. High: 26 pages have no canonical tag (Google)

Evidence: the 101 product pages include a self-referencing www canonical; the homepage, all category pages, all 7 install pages, /packages/, /faq/, /about/, /locations/ and the policy pages have none (26 pages, listed in pages.csv with an empty canonical column). Fix: emit a self-referencing absolute canonical in the shared layout for every indexable page.

5. High: product pages are thin and templated (Google, AI)

Evidence: about 245 words per product URL, nearly all shared header/footer boilerplate; unique content is a price, "Mono 600W RMS", and one sentence. H1 omits the brand (for example "Club A600", "X502-1", "46CXA800.1T") while the title has it. No specs, compatibility, fitment or install-time copy, no Product schema. Titles for 50 pages exceed 60 characters (max 89). Titles use "Installed in Los Angeles" although the shop is in Carson. Fix: add brand-inclusive H1s, 100 to 200 words of per-product copy (what it fits, what the install includes, time), Product/Offer JSON-LD, and shorten titles to roughly 60 characters.

6. High: /locations/ is a 123-city drive-time list (Google)

Evidence: 123 city names with miles (verified count), no per-city content, no map embed, H1 is just "LA Car Stereo", title is "Locations | LA Car Stereo | LA Car Stereo" (brand repeated). It is also currently the only indexable page. A bare list of 123 towns risks being treated as a doorway-style page and gives no local relevance signal beyond town names; the claim "We serve the entire LA area" is stretched by Lancaster at 86.8 mi. Fix: make the page an honest service-area page (shop details, directions, map, 10 to 15 nearby cities with real drive-time guidance) and consider a few genuine pages for South Bay, Long Beach and OC with unique content. Confirm no doorway pattern.

7. Medium: sitemap quality (Google)

Evidence: 127 URLs, all with the identical lastmod 2026-10-04T01:43:08.821Z (a build timestamp, not a real modification date); every listed URL except 3 is noindex, which Search Console reports as "Submitted URL marked noindex"; /brands/ is orphaned (in the sitemap, not linked from crawled pages); 7 /packages// pages, 5 dash-camera products, /reviews/, /contact/ are linked but missing from the sitemap. Fix: generate lastmod from real content changes, include only indexable URLs, add the missing indexable ones.

8. Medium: title and meta description issues (Google)

Evidence: home and /faq/ share the identical meta description ("Car stereo, subwoofers, amps and speakers, priced with install, in Carson."); /gallery/ description is 34 characters and /about/ 63; home title is only "LA Car Stereo: Car Stereo, Installed" with no location. No og:image or twitter:image on the pages checked (twitter:card is summary_large_image but no image is supplied). Fix: unique descriptions of 120 to 155 characters, add Carson/ Los Angeles to the homepage title, add a 1200x630 og:image.

9. Medium: price consistency (Google, trust)

Evidence: install pages and product pages say labor "from $149"; the F-150 package page lists "Installation $300" and "About 2 hours in the bay". May be a legitimate difference (package vs minimum) but is unexplained on-page. Fix: state what drives the labor figure, or reconcile.

10. Medium: no first-hand proof content (Google, AI)

Evidence: /about/ is about 237 words with no named people; "Nick" appears only on /locations/; the homepage deliberately does not reproduce reviews ("We have not reprinted the reviews here"); /reviews/ and /gallery/ are noindex and thin (217 words on /gallery/). Reviews live only on Google, so neither search engines nor AI crawlers can quote them from this site. Fix: add named installer(s), years of experience, certifications if any, a few quoted reviews with attribution and a link to the Google profile, and indexable gallery captions (vehicle, parts, time).

11. Low: security headers (Google, minor)

Evidence from the homepage response: HSTS max-age 63072000 (no includeSubDomains or preload), X-Content-Type-Options nosniff, X-Frame-Options DENY, Referrer-Policy strict-origin-when-cross-origin, Permissions-Policy set. No Content-Security-Policy. `access-control-allow-origin: *` is set on HTML. Good baseline; CSP is the main gap.

12. Low: performance and mobile signals (unverified lab data)

Evidence: viewport meta present; Next.js on Vercel; homepage HTML 118 KB with 13 script tags, CSS 38 KB, TTFB about 0.16 s from the sandbox (cache HIT); product images served via /_next/image (about 13 KB at w=3840 for a sample). /packages/ car pages are about 185 to 240 KB of HTML. Real CWV (LCP, INP, CLS) was not measured because the PageSpeed API was quota-limited. Run PageSpeed Insights or CrUX once the site is indexable.

13. Low: images

Evidence: every page has one logo image with `alt=""` (decorative, acceptable); product images carry alt text equal to the model name; /retrofit-screens/ has 101 images (all with alt except the logo). No broken internal links found among 365 unique hrefs sampled; all tested internal URLs returned 200; the 404 template returns a real 404 status.

What is working

- Clean, hand-written titles and H1s on all 26 non-product pages; one H1 per page.
- Consistent NAP across site, schema and sister sites: 22025 S Avalon Blvd Ste A, Carson CA 90745, (310) 513-8800, Mon to Sat 9:30 to 6:00.
- Transparent installed pricing, a strong differentiator for both users and AI answers.
- Valid JSON-LD on every page; Service schema on install pages; BreadcrumbList on the 7 install detail pages and /locations/.
- google-site-verification tag present on the homepage (Search Console ownership appears set up, unverified).

Sister-domain overlap

Fetched and compared: audiomotorsports.com, shop.audiomotorsports.com, teslatintla.com. Not reachable: lacarbeats.com, lacartint.com, lacaralarm.com, amspods.com (unverified). - Identical NAP, phone, hours and "Google 4.8 from 654" claim across all four sites; the reviews belong to one Google profile shared by the network. The text line (213) 429-1092 appears on the sister sites and as the sms: link here but is never shown on lacarstereo.com. - Shared boilerplate: payment-provider copy (Snap Finance, Koalafi, EasyPay, Synchrony), "one bay in Carson" phrasing. Distinctive lacarstereo.com phrases ("Drive out loud", "Order in, 2 to 3 days", "priced with install") did not appear on the three sister pages checked, so the main copy is not duplicated verbatim. - Product overlap risk: shop.audiomotorsports.com sells the same car-audio products (for example Kicker 46CSC654, also on lacarstereo.com) and its homepage H1 is "Shop car stereo in Carson". Its homepage canonical points to https://www.audiomotorsports.com/ rather than itself (verified on the homepage; product-level canonicals not checked). Decide which domain owns "car stereo Carson" and keep the others from competing. - Entity: audiomotorsports.com declares `AutoRepair` with @id https://www.audiomotorsports.com/#business; lacarstereo.com declares its own `AutoPartsStore` @id and lists the hub as parentOrganization and sameAs. Reasonable structure, but see SCHEMA_REPORT.md for conflicts. - audiomotorsports.com and teslatintla.com publish llms.txt; lacarstereo.com does not.

Prioritised fix order

1. Decide launch intent, then remove sitewide noindex on ranking pages (finding 1).

2. Rewrite robots.txt (finding 2).
3. Fix host redirect and canonicals (findings 3, 4).
4. Upgrade product pages and /locations/ (findings 5, 6).
5. Clean sitemap (7), titles and descriptions (8), then schema and AI items in the companion reports.

Schema Report: lacarstereo.com

Date: 2026-10-04. Method: extracted every `application/ld+json` block from the 127 sitemap URLs (raw HTML via curl) and parsed it as JSON. Google Rich Results Test and Schema.org validator were not run (not reachable); validity below means "parses as JSON, uses real schema.org types and properties", otherwise unverified.

Inventory

Pages	Blocks present
119 pages (home, shop categories, product pages, packages hub, FAQ, about, etc.)	`AutoPartsStore` only
7 install pages (/install/carplay, stereo, subwoofer, amplifier, speakers, dsp, luxury)	`AutoPartsStore` + `Service` + `BreadcrumbList`
/locations/	`AutoPartsStore` + `LocalBusiness` + `BreadcrumbList`

All blocks parsed as valid JSON; no deprecated types found. Spot-check of /packages/2009-2014-ford-f-150/ shows `AutoPartsStore`, `Service`, `BreadcrumbList`.

Sitewide business entity (every page)

`@type AutoPartsStore`, `@id https://www.lacarstereo.com/#business`, name "LA Car Stereo", legalName "Audio MotorSports Inc", telephone "(310) 513-8800", foundingDate 2003, full PostalAddress (22025 S Avalon Blvd Ste A, Carson, CA 90745, US), openingHoursSpecification Mon to Sat 09:30 to 18:00, areaServed = 10 cities (Carson, Long Beach, Torrance, Gardena, Compton, Lakewood, San Pedro, Downey, Los Angeles, Inglewood), logo and image (ams-logo.png), parentOrganization Audio MotorSports Inc, sameAs = the six sister sites.

Good: NAP matches visible page text; the @id is reused by Service blocks via `provider`.

Gaps and errors: 1. Missing `geo` (lat/long), `priceRange`, `contactPoint` (the SMS line (213) 429-1092 is used in sms: links but is not in schema or visible text), `hasMap`, `email`, `description`. 2. `sameAs` lists only your own sister domains. It has no Google Business Profile, Yelp, Facebook or other third-party profile on the main entity (a GBP maps link and a Facebook link appear only on the /locations/ duplicate block). Third-party profiles are what help entity disambiguation. 3. `telephone` is "(310) 513-8800"; the hub and Tesla sites use E.164 "+13105138800". Use one format. 4. `image` is the logo, not a photo of the shop or work. 5. `AutoPartsStore` describes a parts retailer. The business is chiefly an installer (the hub declares `AutoRepair`). Consider `["AutoPartsStore","AutoRepair"]` or keep one type consistent across the network. 6. All URLs and @ids use www while the apex host serves pages without redirect (see AUDIT_REPORT.md finding 3).

/locations/ conflicts

- A second entity `LocalBusiness` with `@id https://www.lacarstereo.com/locations/` describes the same shop: same address and phone, but `areaServed` is the State of California (the sitewide block lists 10 cities), different sameAs (maps URL and Facebook), and `description` "Custom car audio installation serving

Southern California". Two business entities for one shop on one page is a conflict. Merge into the single `#business` entity (add the extra sameAs and a district list there).
- Sunday is given as `opens 00:00, closes 00:00`, which can be read as open 24 hours or zero hours. Omit Sunday (closed days are expressed by leaving the day out).
- The visible page claims "123 cities" while schema says California or 10 cities; align them.
- Page text says the shop is in one Carson bay; schema should not imply multi-location.

Install pages

`Service` blocks are valid: name, description, serviceType ("Apple CarPlay Installation in Los Angeles"), provider by @id, areaServed (same 10 cities). Gaps: no `offers` or `priceSpecification` although the pages state "Labor from $149" and "Most cars: same day"; add `Offer` with price 149 and `priceCurrency USD` (or `UnitPriceSpecification` with a minimum). `serviceType` repeats the title rather than naming the service ("Car stereo installation"). BreadcrumbList on install pages omits the Home level (position 1 is "Install").

Missing types

- Product pages (101): no `Product`/`Offer` markup at all, despite visible price, availability ("In stock in Carson", "Order in, 2 to 3 days"), brand, model. Add Product with name, brand, sku/mpn, image, offers (price, priceCurrency, availability, itemCondition; the "(refurb)" item should be RefurbishedCondition), seller = #business. This is the biggest rich-result gap (Google | AI).
- /faq/ (8 Q&A visible): no `FAQPage`. Google restricts FAQ rich results for most sites, but the markup still helps machine parsing; low effort.
- Category pages: no `ItemList`/`CollectionPage`; no `BreadcrumbList` on shop pages or products (only on install and locations pages).
- Homepage: no `WebSite` (name, url) or `Organization` logo separate from the business entity; no `SearchAction` needed.
- /about/: no `AboutPage`, no `Person` for staff.
- Reviews: the site states "4.8 stars, 654 Google reviews" but has no `aggregateRating`. Recommendation: do NOT add it. Google does not use self-served review markup for LocalBusiness, and it risks a manual action. The visible claim should link to the Google profile instead.

Fixes (priority)

1. Merge the duplicate LocalBusiness on /locations/ into #business; fix Sunday hours. Effort quick.
2. Enrich #business: geo, priceRange, contactPoint (both phone and SMS), hasMap, GBP/Yelp/Facebook in sameAs, E.164 phone. Effort quick.
3. Add Product + Offer + BreadcrumbList to the product template. Effort medium.
4. Add Offer to Service blocks; fix Breadcrumb Home level. Effort quick.
5. Add FAQPage to /faq/. Effort quick.
6. Re-validate in Rich Results Test after the noindex is removed (nothing will show in Google until then).

AI Search (GEO) Report: lacarstereo.com

Date: 2026-10-04. Evidence: robots.txt, llms.txt probe, and the HTML of all 127 sitemap URLs fetched with curl. No live AI-engine queries were run (no access), so "would be cited" statements are inference, labelled (unverified).

Summary

AI visibility today is effectively zero by configuration: robots.txt disallows every AI crawler, the pages are marked noindex, and there is no llms.txt. The underlying content has some strong citation raw material (installed prices, FAQ answers, NAP) but it is short and not exposed.

Score (heuristic): Crawler access 0/100, llms.txt 0/100, Passage citability 55/100, Entity clarity 50/100, Structured data 45/100, Brand/third-party signals unverified.

1. AI crawler access (robots.txt)

Full file fetched from https://lacarstereo.com/robots.txt:

```
User-Agent: AdsBot-Google          Allow: /
User-Agent: AdsBot-Google-Mobile   Allow: /
User-Agent: Googlebot              Allow: /locations/
User-Agent: *                      Disallow: /
Sitemap: https://www.lacarstereo.com/sitemap.xml
```

Crawler	Group applied	Result
GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User	`*`	Blocked
ClaudeBot, Claude-SearchBot, Claude-User	`*`	Blocked
PerplexityBot, Perplexity-User	`*`	Blocked
Google-Extended (Gemini training/grounding control token)	`*`	Blocked
Applebot-Extended, CCBot, Bytespider, etc.	`*`	Blocked
Bingbot (feeds Copilot and several AI products)	`*`	Blocked
Googlebot (AI Overviews source)	own group: Allow / locations/ only	Not disallowed anywhere, but every page except 3 is noindex

Comparison: audiomotorsports.com publishes a documented single `User-agent: *` group welcoming answer engines and an llms.txt; teslatintla.com has explicit Allow groups for GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User, ClaudeBot and others. lacarstereo.com is the outlier.

Fix: open robots.txt to `*` (and keep the single-group pattern the hub site documents), allow the AI search bots (OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User, Claude-SearchBot, Claude-User, PerplexityBot, Googlebot, Bingbot). Training bots (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended, CCBot) are a business choice; blocking only those is compatible with being cited by search-style bots. Remove the page-level noindex too, or the bots can fetch but not use the pages.

2. llms.txt

https://lacarstereo.com/llms.txt and /llms-full.txt both return 404 (the site's HTML 404 page). The hub (audiomotorsports.com/llms.txt) and teslatintla.com have working files, so a template exists to copy, including rules like "do not invent APR or monthly amounts". llms.txt is a low-weight, unproven signal; it is useful here mainly as a single place to state the facts below. Next step: publish /llms.txt with business facts (name, legal name, address, phone, SMS line, hours, one-bay Carson shop, service area, installed-price policy, labor from $149, payment providers without terms), links to /shop/*, /install/*, /packages/, /faq/, /locations/.

3. Passage citability

Strong passages (short, self-contained, answer-first), all on noindex pages today: - /faq/: 8 Q&As, for example "Will I keep my steering wheel controls and backup camera? Yes. A stereo install keeps the factory functions that already work..." and "Can you add CarPlay without replacing my screen? Yes. Wireless CarPlay adapters add CarPlay and Android Auto on the factory screen...". Each answer is 20 to 45 words, a good citation size. - /install/carplay/: "What's included" list (head unit, dash kit and harness, steering wheel interface, antenna adapter, camera reconnected, microphone) and "Labor from $149, most cars same day". - Homepage and package pages: concrete installed prices ("2009-2014 Ford F-150 from $629.94 installed, plus sales tax"). - Package pages (for example /packages/2009-2014-ford-f-150/, noindex): itemised price build-up (stereo $459 + parts $29.99 + install $300) and "about 2 hours in the bay". This is the most citable commercial content on the site.

Weak: - Product pages (101) are about 245 words of mostly boilerplate; nothing quotable beyond price. - /about/ and /gallery/ are thin; no dated content, no authors, no statistics with sources. - Homepage intro "Wireless CarPlay, installed today." is marketing copy, not an answer. - The homepage explicitly withholds review text, so there is nothing for an AI to quote about customer experience. - /locations/ is a list of city names with miles, with no explanatory passages.

Next steps: add answer-first intro paragraphs of 40 to 80 words to each install page ("How much does CarPlay installation cost in Carson? ..."), 3 to 5 FAQs per install page, a visible "Last updated" date on pricing, and per-product 100 to 200 words.

4. Entity clarity

- Names used: "LA Car Stereo" (brand), "Audio MotorSports Inc" (legal name, in footer and schema), "Audio MotorSports" (hub), "AMS". The relationship is stated ("An Audio MotorSports Inc shop") and mirrored in schema via parentOrganization and sameAs. Good.
- Consistent NAP and hours with the hub, Tesla Tint and shop sites (verified on 3 of 7 sister domains).
- Weak: schema sameAs has no third-party profiles on the main entity (no GBP, Yelp, Facebook, social); the hub site shows Yelp 4.7 from 777 and Google 4.8 from 654, but lacarstereo.com shows only Google and does not link a Yelp page. No Wikipedia, Wikidata or press mentions were checked (unverified). A named person ("Ask for Nick") appears only on /locations/.
- Seven sibling domains share one phone, address and review count. For AI engines this can read as one entity with several brand sites, which is accurate, but each site should state clearly which service it owns to avoid answers mixing them up. shop.audiomotorsports.com also sells the same car audio under "Shop car stereo in Carson".

5. Brand and third-party signals (unverified)

Not measurable from here: Reddit, YouTube, Yelp, forum and directory mentions, Google Business Profile completeness, AI engine answers for "car stereo installation Carson". Recommended manual test once crawlable: ask ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Mode "best car stereo install in Carson / Long Beach / Torrance" and "how much does CarPlay install cost in LA" and record which sources appear.

6. Technical rendering for AI crawlers

The pages are server-rendered Next.js (full text is present in the raw HTML; I parsed all content without running JavaScript). This is good for crawlers that do not execute JS. No Markdown alternates, no ai-catalog, no /.well-known files were found (404s tested for /.well-known/security.txt only; others unverified).

Priority actions (GEO)

1. Rewrite robots.txt and drop noindex so AI search bots can fetch pages. quick
2. Publish /llms.txt using the hub file as template. quick
3. Add answer-first intro, FAQ block and Offer schema to the 7 install pages. medium
4. Add third-party profile links (GBP, Yelp, Facebook) to schema sameAs and visible footer. quick
5. Publish a named-people About section, a few attributed reviews with links, and gallery captions. medium
6. Expand product pages with unique copy and Product schema. project